

BAPTIST FAITH & MESSAGE - 2000

CHAPTER XII - EDUCATION



1

BAPTIST FAITH AND MESSAGE COMPARISON

1925

Christianity is the religion of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is therefore a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. An adequate system of schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people. The cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is coordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches.

1963

The cause of education in the kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. An adequate system of Christian schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.

In Christian education there should be a proper balance between academic freedom and academic responsibility. Freedom in any orderly relationship of human life is always limited and never absolute. The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.

The bylaws of BBC currently call the 1963 as our doctrinal standard.

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”

BFM 2000 – Chapter XII

3



SOUTHERN BAPTIST
SEMINARIES, COLLEGES, & UNIVERSITIES

4

Southern Baptist Seminaries

- Gateway Seminary of the Southern Baptist Convention (Ontario, California)
- Midwestern Baptist Theological Seminary (Kansas City, Missouri)
- New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary (New Orleans, Louisiana)
- The Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (Wake Forest, North Carolina)
- The Southwestern Baptist Theological Seminary (Fort Worth, Texas)
- The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary (Louisville, Kentucky)
 - The first SBC seminary which was founded in 1859 by James P. Boyce



5

Southern Baptist Seminaries

- These seminaries are all funded by the Cooperative Program
- Approximately 22% of the Coop. funds goes to these six seminaries as well as the SBC Historical Library and Archives
- If you are in an SBC church and want to go to one of these seminaries, your education will be much more affordable than anywhere else



6

Southern Baptist Colleges

- There are no colleges or universities officially associated with the SBC (outside the 5 that are directly associated with the SBC seminaries)
- The colleges that are SBC affiliated are affiliated only through the state convention (e.g., Alabama Baptist Association)
- The University of Mobile is the only official partner of the ABA

7

Southern Baptist Colleges

- In 1971, there were 71 colleges or universities associated with SBC state conventions across the nation
- In 2008, that number had dropped to 51
- There are currently only 44 schools
- Samford University was founded by Alabama Baptists in 1841, but in 2018 they stopped receiving any funds from the ABA
- Why is this decline happening?

8

The Source of Truth

9

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10

The Source of Truth

- God is the source of all truth, understanding, and wisdom

11

“

Psalm 111:10 (ESV)

*¹⁰ The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom;
all those who practice it have a good understanding.
His praise endures forever!*

”

12

“

*Proverbs 3:5–6 (ESV)**⁵ Trust in the LORD with all your heart,
and do not lean on your own understanding.**⁶ In all your ways acknowledge him,
and he will make straight your paths.*

”

13

“

*John 14:6 (ESV)**⁶ Jesus said to him, “I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.*

”

14

“

Colossians 2:1–3 (ESV)

For I want you to know how great a struggle I have for you and for those at Laodicea and for all who have not seen me face to face, ² that their hearts may be encouraged, being knit together in love, to reach all the riches of full assurance of understanding and the knowledge of God's mystery, which is Christ, ³ in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.

”

15

The Source of Truth

- God is the source of all truth, understanding, and wisdom
- If knowledge and wisdom come from God, then they are gifts of God
- James 1:16–17 (ESV) - ¹⁶ Do not be deceived, my beloved brothers. ¹⁷ Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shadow due to change.
- What kind of people reject God?

16

“

Psalm 14:1 (ESV)

*¹ The fool says in his heart, “There is no God.”
They are corrupt, they do abominable deeds;
there is none who does good.*

”

17

“

Romans 1:19–25 (ESV)

¹⁹ For what can be known about God is plain to them, because God has shown it to them. ²⁰ For his invisible attributes, namely, his eternal power and divine nature, have been clearly perceived, ever since the creation of the world, in the things that have been made. So they are without excuse. ²¹ For although they knew God, they did not honor him as God or give thanks to him, but they became futile in their thinking, and their foolish hearts were darkened.

²² Claiming to be wise, they became fools, ²³ and exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images resembling mortal man and birds and animals and creeping things.

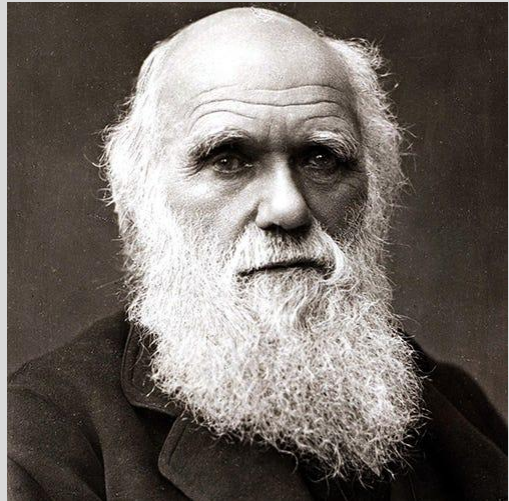
²⁴ Therefore God gave them up in the lusts of their hearts to impurity, to the dishonoring of their bodies among themselves, ²⁵ because they exchanged the truth about God for a lie and worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever! Amen.

”

18

The Fool Says in His Heart...

- Atheism and Agnosticism are filled with intelligent people
- What is the end of all their knowledge?



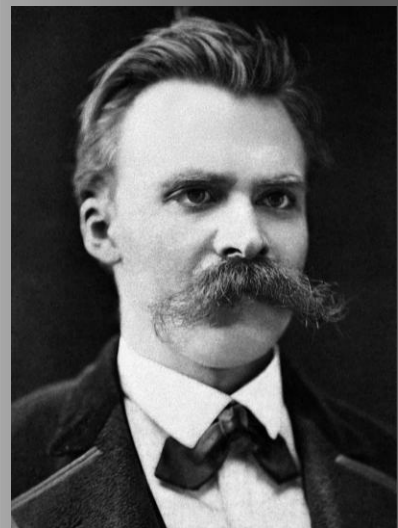
Charles Darwin

19

“Haven't you heard of that madman who in the bright morning lit a lantern and ran around the marketplace crying incessantly, 'I'm looking for God! I'm looking for God!' Since many of those who did not believe in God were standing around together just then, he caused great laughter. Has he been lost, then? asked one. Did he lose his way like a child? asked another. Or is he hiding? Is he afraid of us? Has he gone to sea? Emigrated? - Thus they shouted and laughed, one interrupting the other. The madman jumped into their midst and pierced them with his eyes. 'Where is God?' he cried; 'I'll tell you! We have killed him - you and I! We are all his murderers. But how did we do this? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the sponge to wipe away the entire horizon? What were we doing when we unchained this earth from its sun? Where is it moving to now? Where are we moving to? Away from all suns? Are we not continually falling? And backwards, sideways, forwards, in all directions? Is there still an up and a down? Aren't we straying as though through an infinite nothing? Isn't empty space breathing at us? Hasn't it got colder? Isn't night and more night coming again and again? Don't lanterns have to be lit in the morning? Do we still hear nothing of the noise of the grave-diggers who are burying God? Do we still smell nothing of the divine decomposition? - Gods, too, decompose! God is dead! God remains dead! And we have killed him!

”

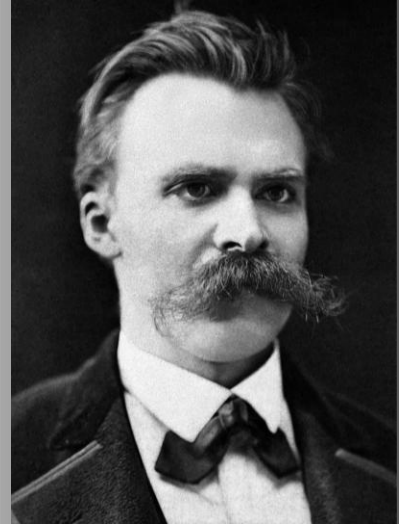
Friedrich Nietzsche, *The Gay Science*, 1882.



20

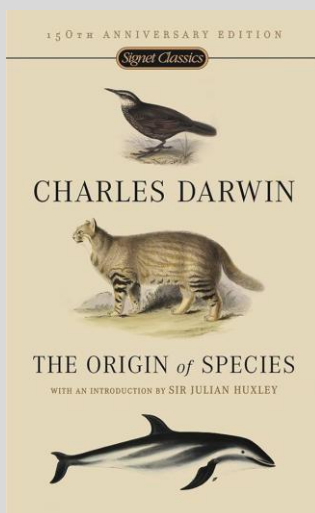
“How can we console ourselves, the murderers of all murderers! The holiest and the mightiest thing the world has ever possessed has bled to death under our knives: who will wipe this blood from us? With what water could we clean ourselves? What festivals of atonement, what holy games will we have to invent for ourselves? Is the magnitude of this deed not too great for us? Do we not ourselves have to become gods merely to appear worthy of it? There was never a greater deed - and whoever is born after us will on account of this deed belong to a higher history than all history up to now!’ Here the madman fell silent and looked again at his listeners; they too were silent and looked at him disconcertedly. Finally he threw his lantern on the ground so that it broke into pieces and went out. ‘I come too early’, he then said; ‘my time is not yet. This tremendous event is still on its way, wandering; it has not yet reached the ears of men. Lightning and thunder need time; the light of the stars needs time; deeds need time, even after they are done, in order to be seen and heard. This deed is still more remote to them than the remotest stars - and yet they have done it themselves!’ It is still recounted how on the same day the madman forced his way into several churches and there started singing his requiem aeternam deo (Grant God eternal rest). Led out and called to account, he is said always to have replied nothing but, ‘What then are these churches now if not the tombs and sepulchres of God?’”

Friedrich Nietzsche, *The Gay Science*, 1882.



21

The Fool Says in His Heart...

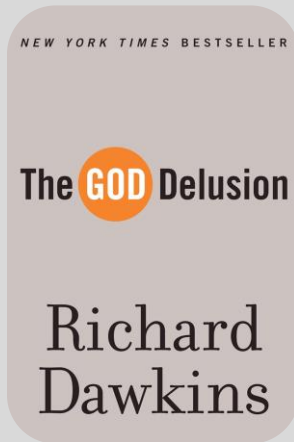


1859

- What does Nietzsche mean that “God is dead”?
- Charles Darwin’s *The Origin of Species* was published in 1859
- For the modern philosopher and scientist, the idea of God’s “death” was a liberation worthy of celebration
- They mock and deride all religious people in their own sense of superiority

22

The Fool Says in His Heart...



2006

- Nietzsche does not mean that God has literally died for he did not believe in God to begin with
- He is asking these Atheists to what end they have been liberated
- If they replace “the idea of God” with “scientism,” what will it lead to?
- “God is dead” essentially means “truth is dead”
- Everything falls into *nihilism*

23

Nihilism Defined

- Nihilism – “the belief that all values are baseless and that nothing can be known or communicated”
 - Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy, <https://iep.utm.edu/nihilism/>
- Real truth cannot be attained or known
- All morality and reason are skeptical
- If there is any meaning in anything, it is only what meaning attributed by an individual
- Everything essentially becomes relative

24

Avoiding Nihilism?

- Some wish to pursue this scientific end while retaining some semblance of God

25

“

I like to live in a culturally Christian country, even if I don't believe a single word of Christian faith.

-Richard Dawkins

<https://www.premierchristianity.com/opinion/richard-dawkins-wants-to-be-a-cultural-christian-but-theres-no-such-thing/17459.article>

”



26

Avoiding Nihilism?



- This is the goal of the modern liberal church
- They keep the idea of God around while endlessly pursuing progressive ideologies
- They hold to everything that the culture believes (or does not believe?) but retain God in whatever image they create Him (or her?) to be

27

Are We There Yet?

- Nietzsche wrote that in 1882, but said that his warning was not for his day
- It is now 2026, has our culture “killed God”?
- We have worked in every way to remove God from everything possible
- “Separation of Church and State” = “Separation of God from Everything in Culture”

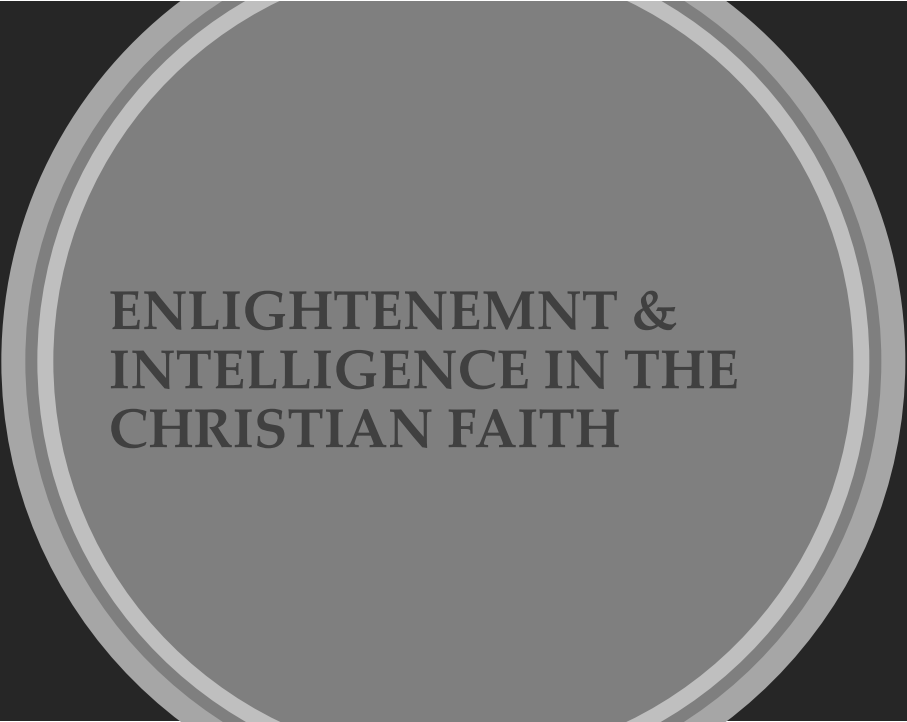
28

To Educate or Not, That is the Question?

- No where has this mantra been pushed more than in our schools in every education level
- God is the source of all truth
- We see what the end of Godless knowledge becomes

[Rhetorical Question] – Can a TRUE education of human beings be separate from God?

29



ENLIGHTENEMNT &
INTELLIGENCE IN THE
CHRISTIAN FAITH

30

“

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Should We Use Our Big Brains?

- The Christian faith is not one of ignorance, no matter how many Christians want to pretend it is and how many Non-Christians want to speak like it is
- Rural Baptists are usually fine with education if it is in the “secular realm” (that is not a thing...)
- It is the theological education they take issue with
- In some instances, there is this sense where the Spirit will just give you all the knowledge you need
- Much of the Christian Church reflects an anti-intellectual bent. Here are some examples:
 - Preaching
 - Modern “Hymns and Spiritual Songs”
 - Bible studies and devotionals
- Later, we will talk about how our worship should be educational

32

“

I am rather fond of the story which used to be told by an American minister, the late Dr. Rufus M. Jones. He believed in the important place of the intellect in preaching. But one of his congregation objected to his emphasis and wrote to him to complain. 'Whenever I go to church,' said his critic, 'I feel like unscrewing my head and placing it under the seat, because in a religious meeting I never have any use for anything above my collar button.'

”

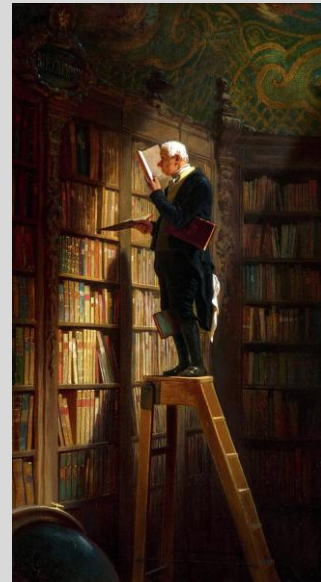
John Stott, *Your Mind Matters*, 44.



33

All Truth from Christ

- All truth comes from God whose knowledge is beyond anything we can comprehend



The Bookworm, Librarian, Carl Spitzweg, source: <https://fineartamerica.com/featured/the-bookworm-librarian-carl-spitzweg.html>

34

“

*Romans 11:33–36 (ESV)**33 Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are his judgments and how inscrutable his ways!**34 “For who has known the mind of the Lord,
or who has been his counselor?”**35 “Or who has given a gift to him
that he might be repaid?”**36 For from him and through him and to him are all things. To him be glory
forever. Amen.*

”

35

All Truth from Christ

- All truth comes from God
- Why do we then say, “In Jesus Christ abide all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge?”

36

“

*John 1:1–5 (ESV)**1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. 2 He was in the beginning with God. 3 All things were made through him, and without him was not any thing made that was made. 4 In him was life, and the life was the light of men. 5 The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome it.*

”

37

“

*Colossians 1:15–20 (ESV)**15 He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. 16 For by him all things were created, in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities—all things were created through him and for him. 17 And he is before all things, and in him all things hold together. 18 And he is the head of the body, the church. He is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in everything he might be preeminent. 19 For in him all the fullness of God was pleased to dwell, 20 and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether on earth or in heaven, making peace by the blood of his cross.*

”

38

“

Hebrews 1:1–3 (ESV)

1 Long ago, at many times and in many ways, God spoke to our fathers by the prophets, 2 but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed the heir of all things, through whom also he created the world. 3 He is the radiance of the glory of God and the exact imprint of his nature, and he upholds the universe by the word of his power. After making purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high,

”

39

“

Colossians 2:1–5 (ESV)

*For I want you to know how great a struggle I have for you and for those at Laodicea and for all who have not seen me face to face, 2 that their hearts may be encouraged, being knit together in love, to reach all the riches of full assurance of understanding and the knowledge of God’s mystery, **which is Christ, 3 in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.** 4 I say this in order that no one may delude you with plausible arguments. 5 For though I am absent in body, yet I am with you in spirit, rejoicing to see your good order and the firmness of your faith in Christ.*

”

40

What Does that Have to do with Us?

- We are made in the image of God
- Does the imago Dei have any implications on education?

41

“

Genesis 1:27–28 (ESV)

*27 So God created man in his own image,
in the image of God he created him;
male and female he created them.*

*28 And God blessed them. And God said to them, “Be fruitful and multiply
and fill the earth and subdue it, and have dominion over the fish of the sea
and over the birds of the heavens and over every living thing that moves on
the earth.”*

”

42

What Does that Have to do with Us?

- We were made to be rational beings who think and learn
- To subdue the Earth means we need to attain knowledge to understand this world better



The Garden of Eden, Jan Brueghel, the Elder, ca. 1610-1612, source: <https://www.museothyssen.org/en/collection/artists/brueghel-jan-elder/garden-eden>

43

The Mind of Christ

- The Christian has the mind of Christ through the indwelling of the Holy Spirit
- 1 Corinthians 2:6-16

44

“

Colossians 2:8–10 (ESV)

8 See to it that no one takes you captive by philosophy and empty deceit, according to human tradition, according to the elemental spirits of the world, and not according to Christ. 9 For in him the whole fullness of deity dwells bodily, 10 and you have been filled in him, who is the head of all rule and authority.

”

45

Yes. Please Use Your Big Brain.

- As people who have the Spirit of God, we are called out of the sloth of unlearnedness
- In our regeneration (new birth), we are new creatures who should seek to learn and grow in our understanding
- God has always called His people to learn and to grow
- He calls us to excellence
- 1 Corinthians 10:31 (ESV)- “So, whether you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God.”

46

“

Proverbs 3:13–23 (ESV)

¹³ Blessed is the one who finds wisdom,
and the one who gets understanding,
¹⁴ for the gain from her is better than gain from silver
and her profit better than gold.
¹⁵ She is more precious than jewels,
and nothing you desire can compare with her.
¹⁶ Long life is in her right hand;
in her left hand are riches and honor.
¹⁷ Her ways are ways of pleasantness,
and all her paths are peace.
¹⁸ She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her;
those who hold her fast are called blessed.
¹⁹ The LORD by wisdom founded the earth;
by understanding he established the heavens;
²⁰ by his knowledge the deeps broke open,
and the clouds drop down the dew.
²¹ My son, do not lose sight of these —
keep sound wisdom and discretion,
²² and they will be life for your soul
and adornment for your neck.
²³ Then you will walk on your way securely,
and your foot will not stumble.

”

47



The Beginning of Learning

48



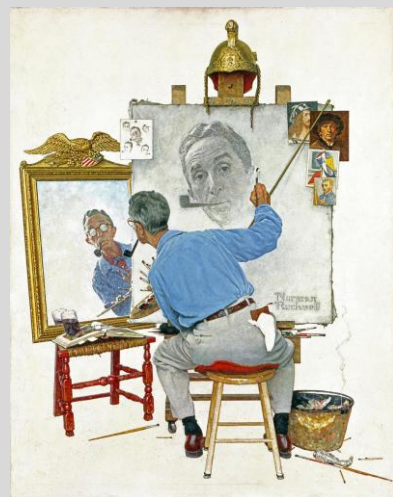
The Student (Standing Young Man at the Window in his Study Reading), William Drost (1653), source: <https://www.topartprint.com/artists/Willem-Drost/art-print/5555/The-Student-Standing-Young-Man-at-the-Window-in-his-Study-Reading.php?srltid=AfmBOoJldzdv-clOcbn3Yg12duUTgOHS3hMm2upZbErqj1pEK8lCi6T>

What does it really mean to learn?

49

Whose Job is It Anyway?

- Where does learning begin?
- It starts with you
- No one can make you learn things
- You must have the discipline and desire to grow in your understanding



Triple Self-Portrait, Norman Rockwell (1960).

50

An Obligation?

- Is it okay for a Christian to NOT grow in knowledge and wisdom?

51

“

1 *Corinthians* 3:1–4 (ESV)

3 But I, brothers, could not address you as spiritual people, but as people of the flesh, as infants in Christ. 2 I fed you with milk, not solid food, for you were not ready for it. And even now you are not yet ready, 3 for you are still of the flesh. For while there is jealousy and strife among you, are you not of the flesh and behaving only in a human way? 4 For when one says, “I follow Paul,” and another, “I follow Apollos,” are you not being merely human?

”

52

“

Hebrews 5:11–6:3 (ESV)

¹¹ About this we have much to say, and it is hard to explain, since you have become dull of hearing. ¹² For though by this time you ought to be teachers, you need someone to teach you again the basic principles of the oracles of God. You need milk, not solid food, ¹³ for everyone who lives on milk is unskilled in the word of righteousness, since he is a child. ¹⁴ But solid food is for the mature, for those who have their powers of discernment trained by constant practice to distinguish good from evil.

⁶ Therefore let us leave the elementary doctrine of Christ and go on to maturity, not laying again a foundation of repentance from dead works and of faith toward God, ² and of instruction about washings, the laying on of hands, the resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment. ³ And this we will do if God permits.

”

53

“

1 Peter 2:2–3 (ESV)

² Like newborn infants, long for the pure spiritual milk, that by it you may grow up into salvation — ³ if indeed you have tasted that the Lord is good.

”

54

“

Philippians 2:12–13 (ESV)

¹² Therefore, my beloved, as you have always obeyed, so now, not only as in my presence but much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling, ¹³ for it is God who works in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure.

”

55

“

Romans 12:1–2 (ESV)

12 I appeal to you therefore, brothers, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and acceptable to God, which is your spiritual (λογικός - reasonable) worship. 2 Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God, what is good and acceptable and perfect.

”

56

“

Colossians 1:9–14 (ESV)

9 And so, from the day we heard, we have not ceased to pray for you, asking that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, 10 so as to walk in a manner worthy of the Lord, fully pleasing to him: bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the knowledge of God; 11 being strengthened with all power, according to his glorious might, for all endurance and patience with joy; 12 giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in light. 13 He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son, 14 in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins.

”

57

Onward to Maturity!

- We have a scriptural mandate to grow in knowledge, **beginning with** our knowledge of God and the Christian faith
- Everyone must grow according to the best of their own abilities
- The immaturity of Christians in a congregation hurts that congregation because everything must remain surface level
- It also hurts our Christian witness and our ability to influence the world toward good

58

Developing the Mind

- What is the primary place where education should happen?
- In the home



https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Family_Worship.jpg

59

“ Deuteronomy 6:1–9 (ESV)

The Greatest Commandment

6 “Now this is the commandment—the statutes and the rules—that the LORD your God commanded me to teach you, that you may do them in the land to which you are going over, to possess it, 2 that you may fear the LORD your God, you and your son and your son’s son, by keeping all his statutes and his commandments, which I command you, all the days of your life, and that your days may be long. 3 Hear therefore, O Israel, and be careful to do them, that it may go well with you, and that you may multiply greatly, as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has promised you, in a land flowing with milk and honey.

4 “Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is one. 5 You shall love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your might. 6 And these words that I command you today shall be on your heart. 7 You shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise. 8 You shall bind them as a sign on your hand, and they shall be as frontlets between your eyes. 9 You shall write them on the doorposts of your house and on your gates.

”

60

“

Deuteronomy 11:18–21 (ESV)

18 “You shall therefore lay up these words of mine in your heart and in your soul, and you shall bind them as a sign on your hand, and they shall be as frontlets between your eyes. 19 You shall teach them to your children, talking of them when you are sitting in your house, and when you are walking by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise. 20 You shall write them on the doorposts of your house and on your gates, 21 that your days and the days of your children may be multiplied in the land that the LORD swore to your fathers to give them, as long as the heavens are above the earth.

”

61

“

Proverbs 22:6 (ESV)

*6 Train up a child in the way he should go;
even when he is old he will not depart from it.*

”

62

“

*Ephesians 6:4 (ESV)**4 Fathers, do not provoke your children to anger, but bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord.*

”

63

“

*1 Corinthians 14:33–35 (ESV)**As in all the churches of the saints, 34 the women should keep silent in the churches. For they are not permitted to speak, but should be in submission, as the Law also says. 35 If there is anything they desire to learn, let them ask their husbands at home. For it is shameful for a woman to speak in church.*

”

64

Education in the Home

- The development of human beings is primarily at home
- Sadly, we have delegated this task to our schools and churches (children's ministries & youth ministries)
- We often do everything we can to not be bothered by our children
 - TV
 - Phones/Tablets
 - Video Games
- We waste what time we have been given with these little ones

65

But... It Is SO Difficult...

- We are tired and overwhelmed sometimes
- Maybe we have become too busy?

66

“

*You're gonna miss this,
you're gonna want this back
You're gonna wish these days,
hadn't gone by so fast
These are some good times,
So take a good look around
You may not know it now,
But you're gonna miss this*

”

Trace Adkins, “You’re Gonna Miss This,” 2008.



67



Ephesians 5:15–16 (ESV)

¹⁵Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, ¹⁶making the best use of the time, because the days are evil.

68

But... It Is SO Difficult...

- We are tired and overwhelmed sometimes
- Maybe we have become too busy?
- It is difficult, but these years with these little ones is only a small portion of these lives we have been given (if you live a long life that is...)
- If we believe that children are a blessing given to us by God, it is our duty to raise those children up to the best of our ability
- Does anyone have any educational stuff that you do at home with your children?

69

Family Worship

- How many of you grew up having conversations about God with your parents?
 - This question is not about times where your parents recognized that we need to thank God for what we have (not to downplay the importance and value of that)
 - This question is speaking to conversations around who God is and what we believe as Christians
 - How many of us have had regular, rich doctrinal conversations with our parents?

70

Family Worship

- For those of us who grew up in a Christian home, we can say that our parents taught us how to be faithful to Christ and the Church
- They showed us what it looks like to be a good Christian
- But how many of can truly say that our parents, specifically our fathers, taught us who God has revealed Himself to be through His Word?

71

Family Worship

- Family worship is a practice that has been lost to us Baptists (as have many historical practices)
- Family worship is a practice of setting apart time with your family to worship God in prayer, scripture reading, confessions, singing, and more
- It is a time in which we have conversations with our children about God, asking them questions and letting them ask us questions
- Family worship is one of the greatest tools that we Christian parents have to raise our children in the Lord

72

“ And verily there is one spring and cause of the decay of religion in our day which we cannot but touch upon and earnestly urge a redress of, and that is the neglect of the worship of God in families by those to whom the charge and conduct of them is committed. May not the gross ignorance and instability of many, with the profaneness of others, be justly charged upon their parents and masters, who have not trained them up in the way wherein they ought to walk when they were young, but have neglected those frequent and solemn commands which the Lord hath laid upon them, so to catechise and instruct them that their tender years might be seasoned with the knowledge of the truth of God as revealed in the Scriptures; and also by their own omission of prayer and other duties of religion of their families, together with the ill example of their loose conversation, having, inured them first to a neglect and the contempt of all piety and religion? We know this will not excuse the blindness and wickedness of any, but certainly it will fall heavy upon those that have been thus the occasion thereof; they indeed die in their sins, but will not their blood be required of those under whose care they were, who yet permitted them to go on without warning - yea, led them into the paths of destruction? And will not the diligence of Christians with respect to the discharge of these duties in ages past rise up in judgment against and condemn many of those who would be esteemed such now? ”

1689 London Confession, Introduction

73

Rules for Family Worship

1	Start slow and start small •If you do too much too quickly, you will fail
2	Be energetic (don't be boring)
3	Let them be Children •Do not set the bar too high •So what if they get a little rambunctious?
4	Mind your temper •Do you want their memories of family worship being your anger? •If you lose it, confess it to them
5	Keep it short •If you are new to FW, 5 minutes max •With young children, try to stay below 20 minutes even if you have been doing FW for a long time.



74

A Parent's Arsenal

- The Bible
- Children's Bibles
- Catechisms
 - *A Catechism for Boys and Girls*
 - *The Baptist Catechism*
 - *New City Catechism*
- Memory Verses

75

Consistency
Consistency
Consistency

76

- Do any of you practice family worship?
 - If so, what do you do?
 - What have been your challenges?
 - What fruits has it produced?



77

My Approach

Family Worship

CALL TO WORSHIP

Hear God call the family to worship and respond in unison:

Make a joyful noise to the Lord, all the earth!

Serve the Lord with gladness!

Come into his presence with singing!

Psalms 100:1-2

Or:

Praise the Lord!

Oh give thanks to the Lord, for he is good,

His steadfast love endures forever!

Psalms 136:1

CONFESSION

Have everyone kneel down on their knees as they confess to the Lord.

Optional: Take a moment and give each family member an opportunity to confess their sins verbally.

The father prays on behalf of the family:

Almighty and most merciful Father,

we have sinned against you

and done what was evil in your sight.

We have done things we should not do,

and we have not done things we should do.

O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Grant us to live a godly and righteous life,

To the glory of your holy Name. Amen.

Psalms 51:4

Psalms 51:1

ASSURANCE OF PARDON

Receive the Word of God as the father reads:

God has said in His Word that:

Jesus Christ the righteous.

He is the propitiation for our sins.

If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to

forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from

all unrighteousness.

1 John 2:1-2

1 John 1:9

SONG OF ADORATION*

Sing a song of your choosing with your family in worship to God.

THE REQUIREMENTS OF GOD*

The father holds out his fist and asks the question which the whole family responds

while raising a finger for each answer:

What does the Lord your God require of you?

1. Fear the Lord your God

2. Walk in all his ways

3. Love him

4. Serve the Lord with all your heart

and all your soul

5. Keep the commandments and

statutes of the LORD

Deuteronomy 10:12-13

GLORIA PATRI OR DOXOLOGY*

Sing together:

Gloria Patri:

Glorify be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;

As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,

World without end. Amen. Amen.

Or:

Doxology:

Praise God from whom all blessings flow;

Praise Him all creatures here below;

Praise Him above you heavenly hosts;

Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

MEMORY VERSE

Either recite the memory verse together or have the children do it individually.

Conclude the verse by saying:

The word of the Lord,

Thanks be to God.

BIBLE LESSON OR CATECHISM

The father leads the family in a Bible lesson or a catechism question.

PRAYER*

Take turns letting everyone pray and conclude with the Lord's Prayer in unison:

Our Father in heaven,

Hallowed be your name.

Your kingdom come,

your will be done,

on earth as it is in heaven.

Give us this day our daily bread,

and forgive us our debts,

as we forgive our debtors.

And lead us not into temptation

but deliver us from evil.

For yours is the kingdom, and the power,

and the glory, forever. Amen.

APOSTLES' CREED*

Confess together what you believe about the Christian faith:

I believe in God, the Father almighty,

creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord.

He was conceived by the Holy Spirit

and born of the Virgin Mary.

He suffered under Pontius Pilate,

was crucified, died and was buried.

He descended to the dead.

On the third day he rose again.

He ascended into heaven,

and is seated at the right hand of the Father.

He will come again to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,

the holy catholic Church,

the communion of saints,

the forgiveness of sins,

the resurrection of the body,

and the life everlasting. Amen.

78

Have Guts and Grit

- There are many tools at your disposal in family worship
- However, none of them will be effective if you are not first committed in your own heart by your convictions

79

“

Before beginning, however, parents must be convinced that it is the right thing to do. A purely pragmatic commitment will soon surrender to difficult circumstances: tiredness, busy schedule, apparent lack of success, periodic resistance and lack of responsiveness. Parents must, therefore, enter with conviction to persevere because of the rightness of teaching definite truth, because of affections set on things above, and because of the duty to rear children in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

Tom Nettles, *Teaching Truth, Training Hearts*
(Founders Press: Cape Coral, FL, 2017), pp. 148-149. ”



80

Beyond the Home

- Homeschooling and co-ops might be the best option for educating our children?
- While the home is the primary place education should happen, we *can* rely on churches and schools
- However, when we rely on institutions, we must question if these institutions are:
 - Actually fulfilling what they set out to fulfill
 - Are good places to send our children for education
 - Be thinking about what is best for our children and not just settling for what is easiest and most comfortable

[Rhetorical Question] – **Can a TRUE education of human beings be separate from God?**

81



Education and Missions

82

“ Christianity is the faith of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ abide all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is, therefore, a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. **Moreover, the cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. An adequate system of Christian education is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.**

In Christian education there should be a proper balance between academic freedom and academic responsibility. Freedom in any orderly relationship of human life is always limited and never absolute. The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.

”

BFM 2000 – Chapter XII

83

“

Matthew 28:16–20 (ESV)

The Great Commission

*16 Now the eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain to which Jesus had directed them. 17 And when they saw him they worshiped him, but some doubted. 18 And Jesus came and said to them, “All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. 19 **Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, 20 teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you.** And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age.”*

”

84

What is a Disciple?

- μαθητεύω (**matheteuo**) – to cause to be a pupil, teach
- Our mission does not stop at baptism, but we are to make people students of the Word of God
- For Christians, education has always found a place of major importance in our missions
- Christians have taught people to read for the purpose of teaching them the Bible
- Creating schools serve as an incredible way of sharing the Gospel

85

Christians in Our Public Schools

- For Christian teachers in America, you have an amazing opportunity to share the Gospel and create disciples of Christ daily
- Are we sending our kids into public schools as “missionaries”?

86

“ Christianity is the faith of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ abide all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is, therefore, a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. Moreover, the cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. **An adequate system of Christian education is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.**

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”

BFM 2000 – Chapter XII

87

The Necessity of a Christian Education

- If we are making disciples, then it is necessary that we build them up completely as mature Christians
- For our development of disciples to be complete, we believe that a *Christian* education is necessary

88

Defining Education

- What is education?

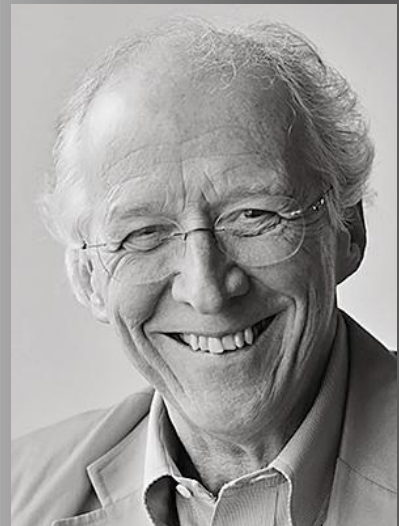
89

“

Education is the instilling of habits of mind and habits of heart that incline and enable students for the rest of their lives to do six things:

- 1. Observe the world carefully*
- 2. Understand what they have observed clearly*
- 3. Evaluate what you have seen and understood fairly*
- 4. Feel that evaluative reality proportionately*
- 5. Apply all those discoveries wisely*
- 6. Express clearly, accurately, creatively, winsomely with your body and with your mouth and with your writing in the world for the good of the world*

John Piper, “What Sets Christian Education Apart?,” *Desiring God*, 02:15, YouTube:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RvwT04C6QGo&t=1012s>”



90

The Necessity of Christian Education

- What is a Christian education?
- Do we believe that a Christian education is necessary?
- Why then do we not give our own children one?

91

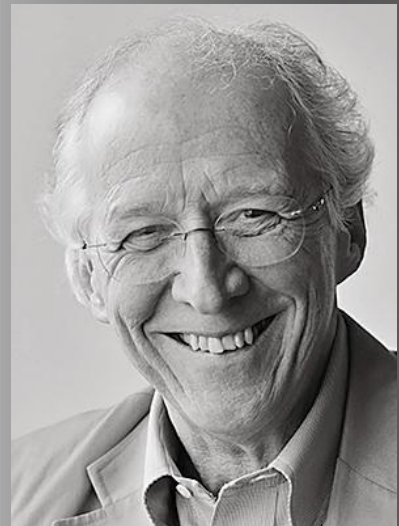
“

What would make it Christian?... Education is Christian if it has four elements to it:

- 1. All of it is pursued in conscious reliance upon the gracious empowering of the Holy Spirit.*
- 2. Jesus Christ is trusted for the basis of that empowerment.*
- 3. You do all of that for the glory of God in Christ.*
- 4. It's governed by the authority of the Bible.*

John Piper, "What Sets Christian Education Apart?," *Desiring God*, 02:15, YouTube: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RvwT04C6QGo&t=1012s>

”



92

The Necessity of Christian Education

- Do we believe that a Christian education is necessary?
- Why are we not at least trying to make a way to give such an education to our own children?

93



Freedom in Education

94

“ Christianity is the faith of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ abide all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is, therefore, a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. Moreover, the cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. **An adequate system of Christian education is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.**

In Christian education there should be a proper balance between academic freedom and academic responsibility. Freedom in any orderly relationship of human life is always limited and never absolute. The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.

”

BFM 2000 – Chapter XII

95

Christian Liberty

- Freedom is a core tenant of Christianity
- John 8:36 – “So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.”
- James 2:12 – “So speak and so act as those who are to be judged under the law of liberty.”
- For Baptists, liberty of conscience is a major part of our beliefs
 - We will cover liberty of conscience in Article XVII Religious Liberty

96

Academic Freedom

- What is academic freedom?
- The liberty to pursue truth and understanding without fear of censorship, retribution, or interference
- Teachers and students are free to discover and explore the topics they choose and are free to draw conclusions, present those conclusions, and to debate those conclusions
- Academic freedom does not protect one from critique of others for they too are free to repudiate your findings and claims, which is a necessary part of education

97

Danger! Danger!

- Does the idea of academic freedom scare you?
- What are the risks of letting someone have academic freedom?
- Should we let the risks stop us from a full pursuit of education?



98

Freedom is Not Absolute

- Freedom does have boundaries
- If truth is objective and real, then you are not free to believe whatever you want
 - 2+2 cannot equal 5
 - Boys cannot become girls
- This is why debate, peer reviews, and other such things are so important



99

Other Limiting Factors

“The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.” – BFM

- The BFM lists 3 limits to academic freedom:
 1. The pre-eminence (superiority) of Jesus Christ
 2. The authority of Scriptures
 3. The mission of the institution

100

BAPTIST FAITH AND MESSAGE COMPARISON

1925

Christianity is the religion of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is therefore a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. An adequate system of schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people. The cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is coordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches.



1963

The cause of education in the kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. An adequate system of Christian schools is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.

In Christian education there should be a proper balance between academic freedom and academic responsibility. Freedom in any orderly relationship of human life is always limited and never absolute. The freedom of a teacher in a Christian school, college, or seminary is limited by the pre-eminence of Jesus Christ, by the authoritative nature of the Scriptures, and by the distinct purpose for which the school exists.

2000

Christianity is the faith of enlightenment and intelligence. In Jesus Christ abide all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. All sound learning is, therefore, a part of our Christian heritage. The new birth opens all human faculties and creates a thirst for knowledge. Moreover, the cause of education in the Kingdom of Christ is co-ordinate with the causes of missions and general benevolence, and should receive along with these the liberal support of the churches. An adequate system of Christian education is necessary to a complete spiritual program for Christ's people.

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101

SBC Inerrancy Controversy

102

Different Names

- The inerrancy controversy was about many different progressive theological views
- The primary issue was about biblical inerrancy and infallibility
- This controversy goes by two different names, depending on who is speaking about it:
 - The Fundamentalist Takeover
 - The Conservative Resurgence
- With that being said, let's explore the **Conservative Resurgence** of the 20th Century

103

Setting the Mood

- The 19th century saw a lot of growth and good things happen within the Church
- There were also many things that set us on a negative trajectory
 - The aftermath of the Enlightenment
 - Major Divisions in American Baptists
 - Rugged American Individualism
 - Baptist Landmarkism
 - Weakening/Losses of Baptist Confessionalism
 - Revivalism
 - Scientific Progress (Geology, Evolution, Psychology, Sociology)

104

Disagreement Around Education

- Many Baptists in the early 1800s were against theological education of any kind
- This disagreement along with resistance to Baptist Societies caused a major split amongst American Baptists
 - Missions Societies
 - Tract Societies
 - Bible Societies
 - Sunday School
 - Revivals (Protracted Meetings)
- Statements like the Kehukee Declaration (1827) and the Black Rock Address (1832) led many Baptists to separate themselves from other Baptists
- Many of these churches would become Independent Baptists or Primitive Baptists

105

“Colleges and Theological Schools next claim our attention. In speaking of Colleges, we wish to be distinctly understood that it is not to colleges, collegial education, as such, that we have objection. We would cheerfully afford our own children such an education, did circumstances warrant the measure. But we object, in the first place, to sectarian colleges, as such. The idea of a Baptist College, and of a Presbyterian College, &c., necessarily implies that our distinct views of church government of gospel doctrine and gospel ordinances, are connected with human sciences, a principle which we cannot admit: we believe the kingdom of Christ to be altogether a kingdom not of this world. In the second place, we object to the notion of attaching professorships of divinity to colleges; because this evidently implies that the revelation which God has made of himself is a human science, on a footing with mathematics, philosophy, law, &c., which is contrary to the general tenor of revelation, and indeed to the very idea of a revelation. We perhaps need not add that we have for the same reason strong objection to colleges conferring the degree of Doctor of Divinity, and to preachers receiving it.”

Black Rock Address of 1832

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“ Thirdly, We decidedly object to persons, after professing to have been called of the Lord to preach His gospel, going to a college or academy to fit themselves for that service. 1st. Because we believe that Christ possesses perfect knowledge of his own purposes, and of the proper instruments by which to accomplish them. If he has occasion for a man of science, he having power over all flesh, will so order it that the individual shall obtain the requisite learning before he calls him to his service, as was the case with Saul of Tarsus, and others since; and thus avoid subjecting himself to the imputation of weakness. For should Christ call a person to labor in the gospel field, who was unqualified for the work assigned him, it would manifest him to be deficient in knowledge relative to the proper instruments to employ, or defective in power to provide them. 2nd. Because we believe that the Lord calls no man to preach his gospel, till he has made him experimentally acquainted with that gospel, and endowed him with the proper measure of gifts, suiting the field he designs him to occupy; and the person giving himself up in obedience to the voice of Christ will find himself learning in Christ’s own school. ”

Black Rock Address of 1832

107

“ But when a person professedly called of Christ to the gospel ministry, concludes that, in order to be useful, he must first go and obtain an academical education, he must judge that human science is of more importance in the ministry, than that knowledge and those gifts which Christ imparts to his servants. To act consistently then with his own principles, he will place his chief dependence for usefulness on his scientific knowledge, and aim mostly to display this in his preaching. This person, therefore, will pursue a very different course in his preaching, from that marked out by the great apostle to the Gentiles, who determined to know nothing among the people save Jesus Christ and him crucified. ”

Black Rock Address of 1832

108

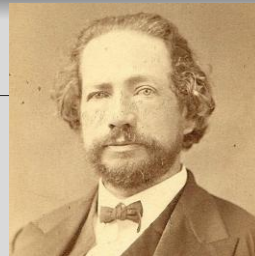
SBC Beginnings in Education

- From the 1830s, Baptists in the South recognized the need for a theological seminary with sound Biblical teaching
- In May of 1845, Baptists from the South met in Augusta, GA to form the Southern Baptist Convention

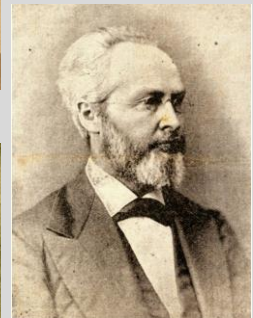
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Baptists Giants

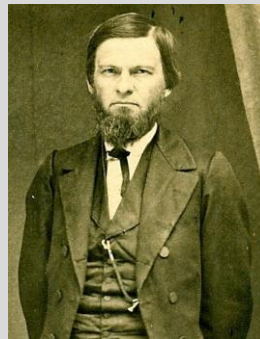
- James Petigru Boyce (1827-1888)
 - Graduated from Brown University
 - Professor at Furman University
- Basil Manly, Jr. (1825-1892)
 - Valedictorian at the University of AL
 - Masters from Princeton Seminary
- John A. Broadus (1827-1895)
 - Graduate and professor at University of Virginia



JP Boyce



Basil Manly, Jr.



John A. Broadus

110

Boyce and Manly

- Boyce and Manly grew up at Charleston Baptist Church under the pastor, Basil Manly, Sr.
- Charleston was the first Baptist church in the South, founded in 1682
- FBC Charleston was been a major church for Baptists in the South in the 18th and 19th Centuries
- They held to the Charleston Confession (The 1689 London Baptist Confession) which every church that met to form the SBC also held to
- Basil Manly, Sr. played a major role in shaping these two men



FBC Charleston, 1822

111

Three Changes

- Boyce gave an address to a meeting of South Carolina Baptists in 1856 where he presented “Three Changes in Theological Institutions”:
1. Baptists seminaries should no longer require a classical education (Greek and Latin) as a prerequisite
 2. The seminary should have a first-rate research library and offer courses in advanced scholarship
 3. The seminary should be founded upon a confession of faith

112

Call for a Confession

- Boyce had the foresight to recognize that something needed to protect the seminary from theological error
- He saw the many different theological errors that were tearing apart Baptists in America
- Many theological schools were already being plagued with heresies, like Harvard Divinity School which would be lost to Unitarianism by the end of the 18th century

113

“

Campbellism, though checked in every direction in which it attempted to develop itself, has left no little of its leaven among us and exerts no inconsiderable influence. The distinctive principles of Arminianism have also been engrafted upon many of our churches; and even some of our ministry have not hesitated to publicly avow them. That sentiment, the invariable precursor, or accompaniment of all heresy – that doctrines of theology are matters of mere speculation, and its distinctions only logomachines and technicalities, has obtained at least a limited prevalence. And the doctrinal sentiments of a large portion of the ministry and membership of the churches are seen to be either very much unsettled or radically wrong.

James P. Boyce, “Three Changes in Theological Institutions”, 1856.

”



James P. Boyce 1827-1888

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“*Sad will be the day for this university should such sentiments ever obtain prevalence in your board or receive the sanction of any of your theological professors. And yet that this is not impossible is evident from the history of others similarly situated. The day has already come when it has been made matter of congratulation in a Baptist journal of high standing that at the examination of perhaps the best endowed and most flourishing Baptist theological seminary in America the technical terms of theology were no longer heard. A crisis in Baptist doctrine is evidently approaching, and those of us who still cling to the doctrines which formerly distinguished us have the important duty to perform of earnestly contending for the faith once delivered to the saints. Gentlemen, God will call us to judgment if we neglect it.*

James P. Boyce, “Three Changes in Theological Institutions”, 1856.



James P. Boyce 1827-1888

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“*It is with a single man that error usually commences; when such a man has influence or position, it is impossible to estimate the evil that will attend it. Ecclesiastical history is full of warning upon this subject. Scarcely a single heresy has ever blighted the church which has not owed its existence, or its development, to that one man of power and ability whose name has always been associated with its doctrines. And yet seldom has an opinion been thus advanced, which has not subsequently had its advocate in every age, and which in some ages has not extensively prevailed.*

James P. Boyce, “Three Changes in Theological Institutions”, 1856.



James P. Boyce 1827-1888

116

“

The danger which threatened in this instance may assail us again. Another such, and yet another, may arise and, favored by better circumstances, may instill false principles into the minds of his pupils, and sending them forth to occupy the prominent pulpits of the land, may influence all our churches, and the fair fabric of our faith may be entirely demolished.

James P. Boyce, “Three Changes in Theological Institutions”, 1856.

”



James P. Boyce 1827-1888

117

Abstract of Principles

- Boyce suggested that the school adopt the Charleston Confession as their confession of faith
- When the school was founded, they adopted the *Abstract of Principles*, drafted by Basil Manly, Jr.
- These principles are a shortened version of the 1689 *London Baptist Confession*
- Every professor that teaches at SBTS has to pledge agreement with these principles by signing the confession
- Had Boyce not called for a confessional standard, SBTS would be lost to the liberal agenda today, as we will soon see...

118

Founding of a Seminary



- The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary was founded in 1859 in Greenville, South Carolina
- They met at the old First Baptist Church of Greenville meetinghouse to save money
- They had 2 classrooms and a library of 2,000 volumes

119

Troubling Start

- With the explosion of the American Civil War, the seminary had to close in the fall of 1862
- The school lost its endowment and had no path for opening back up
- The faculty committed themselves to the school
- "Suppose we quietly agree that the seminary may die, but we'll die first." – John Broadus

TSBTS
Founded
1859

120

To Louisville

- The school opened again in 1865, but was struggling
- James P. Boyce bled his own financial resources dry to pay salaries
- The school moved to Louisville, Kentucky in 1877 to receive a new endowment

SBTS
Founded
1859

SBTS Closed
1862

121

A Little Leaven

- In 1869, SBTS hired its 5th professor, Crawford Toy (1836-1919)
- Toy began to adopt the new progressive ideologies of his day like an old Earth and Darwinian Evolution
- Though Toy could not reconcile the Bible with his new beliefs, he did not want to give up the truthfulness of the Bible
- Around 1875, Toy would adopt a liberal view of inspiration in which the Bible had an inward spiritual meaning inspired by the Holy Spirit and an outward human meaning
- This view separated the divine and human aspects of scripture



122

A Little Leaven

- Eventually, Toy would deny key interpretations of both the Old and New Testaments
- Toy believed that his views would help hold together the faith of those struggling with the new sciences of his day
- Toy claimed his views aligned with the *Abstract of Principles*
- In 1879, Toy presented a defense of his beliefs along with his resignation to the trustees of the school
- To his surprise, they accepted his resignation and he left the school
- Toy eventually would leave the Church altogether



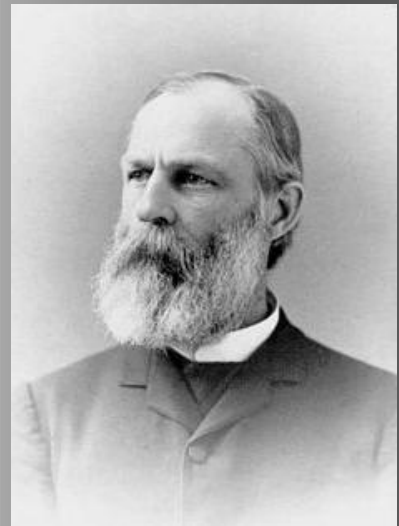
123

“

I am glad to find that we are in accord as to the spirit of Old Testament study, and rejoice that you have spoken so earnestly and vigorously on behalf of the spirit of broad, free, spiritual minded investigation. There is so much work in this country for the advocates of such a view, and it will require patient and wise effort to dislodge the traditional narrowness that has obtained so firm a foothold in some quarters.

C.H. Toy letter to Charles A. Briggs, 1877. Found in Gregory A. Wills, "Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940" in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 64.

”



124

A Little Leaven

- Toy was the first professor in American schools to be dismissed over liberal theology
- Sadly, his views would be minor compared to what will come
- William O. Carver would later write in 1954 that Toy's "views would today not be regarded as sufficiently revolutionary to call for drastic action."

SBTS
Founded
1859

SBTS Closed
1862

SBTS
Opened
1865

Moved to
Kentucky
1877

Toy
Dismissed
1879

125

The Turning of a Century

- James Boyce died in 1888
- John Broadus was the second president of SBTS until (1888-1895)
- Followed by William H. Whitsitt (1895-1899)
- The controversial, Edgar Young Mullins (1860-1928) would become the fourth president in 1899



126

History is Complicated...

- Mullins is a tough figure for Baptists to nail down
- He has been claimed by both liberal Baptists and conservative Baptists as supporting their sides
- Mullins' aim was to bring together progressive and conservative ideas as a mediating theology
- In the early 1900s, progressives and fundamentalists were becoming more hostile
- Fundamentalist in this day was not what we think of today, but was a name given to those that held to the Bible as infallible and wanted to conserve traditional Christian values

127

Mullins' Impact

- SBTS grew tremendously under Mullins and he transformed many aspects of the seminary
- Mullins would also impact the SBC as a whole
- Mullins drafted the 1925 Baptist Faith and Message
- "He did not found the Southern Baptist movement... but he reformulated their faith. He was 'their refounder, the definer of their creedless faith.'"
- Gregory A. Wills, "Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940", in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 69.

128

Mullins Theological Issues

- Though Mullins himself was a Calvinist, he shifted his theological views to a post-enlightenment pattern
- Mullins adopted the philosophies of **Pragmatism** and Personalism, as well as the Enlightenment thinker, Schleiermacher
- For Mullins, theology was not centered on God's revelation, but on religious experience
- "The bases of religious knowledge lie in personality and personal relationships."
 - Found in "E.Y. Mullins: The Axioms of Religion", edited by Timothy and Denise George (Broadman & Homan Publishers, 1997)
- This means that truth is validated by my experiences with God rather than through doctrinal or creedal adherence

129

Mullins Theological Issues

- Mullins was not a theological liberal, but starting from experience rather than revelation is a very different starting place
- This causes a major shift in Baptist theology, opening the door to subjective theology
- "The Christian doctrinal system arises out of the facts of Christian experience."
 - E.Y. Mullins, *Christian Religion* found in Gregory A. Wills, "Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940", in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 69.
- While Mullins may not have intended this outcome, his methodological shift paved the way for ambiguity which plagues the SBC even today

130

“

Mullins transformed the traditional Calvinist orthodoxy of Southern Baptist churches into a more progressive and experientialist faith. Above all, it was a more individualistic faith.

”

Gregory A. Wills, “Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940”, in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 69

131

...Leavens the Whole Lump



- By the 1920s, SBTS had gained a reputation for being a liberal school due to the teaching of one man, William O. Carver (1868-1954)
- Carver served as a professor of missions at SBTS from 1898-1943
- Carver agreed with Mullins that our knowledge of spirituality began in our religious experience

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EY Mullins
becomes
President
1899

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A New Age

- Modernists of this day were arguing that religion was no longer needed
- The sciences could explain everything we needed
 - Sociology now gave us ethical values
 - The mysteries of the world could be solved scientifically
 - Anthropologists believed that Christians introducing their faith to other cultures injured those cultures which had been founded by other views
- The whole concept of missions was being questioned

133

A Weird Career Choice

- Carver also believed that the way missions had been practiced traditionally was no longer needed
- Traditionally, Christian missions were based on presenting the Gospel to a lost people who would perish if they did not repent and believe
- Mullins believed that people already knew God through their experiences with nature and history
- For Carver, missions should be promoted “for the life of the nation, for the salvation of society, for the condition of the world.”
 - William Carver, *Missions and Modern Thought* found in Gregory A. Wills, “Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940”, in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 74.

134

“

Religion alone, Carver felt could muster sufficient resources to save the world from ignorance, hatred, and injustice. It, above all human institutions and ideas, promoted the 'advance of the race.' Christianity was the 'highest religion' and was 'adaptable' to the state of progress in every society.

”

Gregory A. Wills, “Southern Seminary and Progressive Religion 1870-1940”,
in *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* (2009), p. 74.

135

All Religions Lead to God?

- For Carver, God has always been manifesting Himself to humans and Jesus was the logos of God who enlightened us all to Him
- God was progressively revealing Himself through natural and human evolution
- Mullins believed that all religions were leading people toward God and preparing them for the revelation of Jesus Christ

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Rising Tensions

- In the 1960s, the SBC's publishing house, Broadman Press, published a book by Ralph Elliott
- He was a professor at Midwestern Baptist Theological Seminary
- His book denied the historicity of Adam and Eve, that the flood was not worldwide, and that Sodom and Gomorrah were destroyed by natural causes
- He was fired for trying to re-publish the book after a controversy ensued

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becomes
President
1899

BFM is
assembled
1925

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BFM 1925 to 1963 Changes

1925

We believe that the Holy Bible was written by men divinely inspired, and is a perfect treasure of heavenly instruction; that it has God for its author, salvation for its end, and truth, without any mixture of error, for its matter; that it reveals the principles by which God will judge us; and therefore is, and will remain to the end of the world, the true center of Christian union, and the supreme standard by which all human conduct, creeds and religious opinions should be tried.

Luke 16:29-31; 2 Tim. 3:15-17; Eph. 2:20; Heb. 1:1; 2 Peter 1:19-21; John 16:13-15; Matt. 22:29-31; Psalm 19:7-10; Psalm 119:1-8.

1963

The Holy Bible was written by men divinely inspired and is the record of God's revelation of Himself to man. It is a perfect treasure of divine instruction. It has God for its author, salvation for its end, and truth, without any mixture of error, for its matter. It reveals the principles by which God judges us; and therefore is, and will remain to the end of the world, the true center of Christian union, and the supreme standard by which all human conduct, creeds, and religious opinions should be tried. **The criterion by which the Bible is to be interpreted is Jesus Christ.**

Ex. 24:4; Deut. 4:1-2; 17:19; Josh. 8:34; Psalms 19:7-10; 119:11, 89, 105, 140; Isa. 34:16; 40:8; Jer. 15:16; 36; Matt. 5:17-18; 22:29; Luke 21:33; 24:44-46; John 5:39; 16:13-15; 17:17; Acts 2:16ff; 17:11; Rom. 15:4; 16:25-26; 2 Tim. 3:15-17; Heb. 1:1-2; 4:12; 1 Peter 1:23; 2 Peter 1:19-21.

2000

The Holy Bible was written by men divinely inspired and is God's revelation of Himself to man. It is a perfect treasure of divine instruction. It has God for its author, salvation for its end, and truth, without any mixture of error, for its matter. Therefore, all Scripture is totally true and trustworthy. It reveals the principles by which God judges us, and therefore is, and will remain to the end of the world, the true center of Christian union, and the supreme standard by which all human conduct, creeds, and religious opinions should be tried. All Scripture is a testimony to Christ, who is Himself the focus of divine revelation.

Exodus 24:4; Deuteronomy 4:1-2; 17:19; Joshua 8:34; Psalms 19:7-10; 119:11, 89, 105, 140; Isaiah 34:16; 40:8; Jeremiah 15:16; 36:1-24; Matthew 5:17-18; 22:29; Luke 21:33; 24:44-46; John 5:39; 16:13-15; 17:17; Acts 2:16ff; 17:11; Romans 15:4; 16:25-26; 2 Timothy 3:15-17; Hebrews 1:1-2; 4:12; 1 Peter 1:23; 2 Peter 1:19-21.

"The criterion by which the Bible is to be interpreted is Jesus Christ."

138

More Shenanigans

- In 1969, Broadman Press published a Genesis and Exodus commentary that criticized reading the Bible in a literal historical manner
 - For example: It denied that God actually commanded Abraham to sacrifice Isaac
- In 1971, convention messengers passed a pro-choice resolution supporting legalized abortion in certain cases

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“

WHEREAS, Christians in the American society today are faced with difficult decisions about abortion; and
 WHEREAS, Some advocate that there be no abortion legislation, thus making the decision a purely private matter between a woman and her doctor; and
 WHEREAS, Others advocate no legal abortion, or would permit abortion only if the life of the mother is threatened;
 Therefore, be it RESOLVED, that this Convention express the belief that society has a responsibility to affirm through the laws of the state a high view of the sanctity of human life, including fetal life, in order to protect those who cannot protect themselves; and
 Be it further RESOLVED, That we call upon Southern Baptists to work for legislation that will allow the possibility of abortion under such conditions as rape, incest, clear evidence of severe fetal deformity, and carefully ascertained evidence of the likelihood of damage to the emotional, mental, and physical health of the mother

”

“Resolution on Abortion”, 1971 Annual Meeting

140

“

WHEREAS, Southern Baptists have historically held a high view of the sanctity of human life, and
 WHEREAS, The messengers to the Southern Baptist Convention meeting in St. Louis in 1971 adopted overwhelmingly a resolution on abortion, and
 WHEREAS, That resolution reflected a middle ground between the extreme of abortion on demand and the opposite extreme of all abortion as murder, and
 WHEREAS, That resolution dealt responsibly from a Christian perspective with complexities of abortion problems in contemporary society;
 Therefore, be it RESOLVED, that we reaffirm the resolution on the subject adopted by the messengers to the St. Louis Southern Baptist Convention meeting in 1971, and
 Be it further RESOLVED, that we continue to seek God's guidance through prayer and study in order to bring about solutions to continuing abortion problems in our society.

”

“Resolution on Abortion”, 1974 Annual Meeting

141

Hollyfield Thesis

- *A Sociological Analysis of the Degrees of 'Christian Orthodoxy' Among Selected Students in The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary* by Noel Wesley Hollyfield, Jr.

	Diploma students	1 st year M.Div.	Final year M.Div.	Ph.D / Th.M
I know God really exists: I have no doubts about it.	100%	74%	65%	63%
Jesus is the Divine Son of God: I have no doubts about this.	100%	87%	63%	63%
I believe the miracles happened as the Bible said they did.	96%	61%	40%	37%
Jesus was born of a virgin: completely true	96%	66%	33%	32%
Belief in Jesus Christ as Savior: absolutely necessary	100%	85%	60%	59%

Image from: <https://genebrooks.blogspot.com/2010/06/controversy.html>

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A Plan Comes Together

- In SBC Polity, the SBC President appoints several committees, but the Committee on Committees has the most power
- That committee nominates the Committee on Nominations, which nominates members of the boards of trustees
- If a president were to... let's say... nominate the right people onto the Committee on Committees, things could change

143

A Plan Comes Together

- A strategy was formed by Paige Patterson and Paul Pressler to move the SBC in a biblical direction which has become known as the Conservative Resurgence
- Understand that one cannot just take over the SBC by themselves
- The whole plan depends on the messengers showing up and voting the right way



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We Did...

- In 1979, approximately 15,000 messengers gathered in Houston and elected Adrian Rogers to be President with 51% of the vote
- From 1979 to 1990, the messengers showed up and voted in a conservative president every single time
- Only one vote was even close in 1988 with the election of Jerry Vines by 692 votes out of 32,000 votes cast
- In 1985, there were over 45,000 messengers showed up for the convention in what has become known as a “watershed moment” for the SBC
 - The moderates organized every resource available to retake the presidency, but they failed
- By 1990, the moderates stopped putting forward candidates

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Source of the Controversy?

- The progressives claim this controversy was about power (I know... shocking...)
- The resurgence was about holding to scriptural truths
- Imagine where the SBC would be today if messengers had not shown up for 30 years and kept the fight going

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President
1899

BFM is
assembled
1925

Adrian
Rogers
elected
President
1971

Watershed
SBC
Meeting
1985

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What about SBTS?

- In 1993, the trustees of SBTS elected R. Albert Mohler, Jr. as the president of SBTS at the age of 33-years-old
- Dr. Mohler took his presidency with the goal of returning to James P. Boyce's vision
- He delivered his first Convocation Sermon titled, "Don't Just Do Something, Stand There"

147

“ But the importance and impact of the Abstract of Principles and of Southern Seminary reaches much farther. We have arrived at a critical moment for the Southern Baptist Convention and its churches. A denomination once marked by intense theological commitment and a demonstrable theological consensus has seen that doctrinal unity pass into a programmatic consciousness. We are in danger of losing our theological grammar, and, more seriously by far, of forfeiting our theological inheritance.

This crisis far outweighs the controversy which has marked the Southern Baptist Convention for the last fourteen years. That controversy is a symptom rather than the root cause. As Southern Baptists, we are in danger of becoming God's most unembarrassed pragmatists much more enamored with statistics than invested in theological substance. ”

Al Mohler, "Don't Just Do Something, Stand There", 1993.



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“

The Abstract represents a clarion call to start with conviction rather than mere action. It cries out, “Don’t just do something, stand there!” This reverses the conventional wisdom of the world, but it puts the emphasis rightly. Southern Baptists are now much more feverishly concerned with doing than with believing and thus our denominational soul is in jeopardy. This people of God must reclaim a theological tradition which understands all of our denominational activity to be founded upon prior doctrinal commitments. This is true for the denomination at every level and of the local churches as well.

”

Al Mohler, “Don’t Just Do Something, Stand There”, 1993.



149

What about SBTS?

- He planned to enforce the *Abstract of Principles* under its original interpretation
- They were able to remove the liberal influences from the seminary and SBTS has a phenomenal faculty

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The Heart of the Controversy

- The Conservative Resurgence was about scriptural infallibility, ultimately
- However, there is a question that resides at the heart of it all
- It is a question of Baptist Identity
- What does it mean to be a Baptist?
- Is the liberty of the conscience the sole identifier of a Baptist?
- Are Baptists free to believe whatever they want?
- Are we a creedal/confessional people?
- We will answer these questions in another article, I hope.

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152

Is It Over?

- The battle is never done.
- When one generation gives way on doctrine, the next will push that further
- We must always guard against the wolves, especially in our own church

153

Guarding Education in the Church

- If we are going to have people to guard what is taught in our church, that must be done correctly
- Approaching a task like this haphazardly will lead to problems
- If you study Baptist history, you will see both Particular Baptists and General Baptists drifting away from orthodox doctrine in each century
- We must learn from our history

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Assumed Unity

- It is often assumed that people in a church are united in what they believe, but is this assumption accurate?
- Because there is no confessional standard that is spoken of regularly, individuals develop their own beliefs apart from others in the church
- They come to assume that what they believe is what everyone in the church believes (and to some extent what all Baptists believe)
- After this doctrinal drift, anything that threatens the beliefs of an individual or a small group of individuals becomes a major issue (especially if they are in “leadership”)
- To avoid such trials, Baptists steer clear of theological conversations “for the sake of unity”
- Thus, the cycle deepens

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What Should Broadway Do?

- Can a church have unity if they are not united in what they believe?
- “Don’t just do something, stand there.” – Dr. Albert Mohler
- Ambiguity is deadly to a church
- We need to know what we believe, first, and work from there
- Baptists of the 20th century became Pragmatists, abandoning the regard we used to have for doctrine for evangelism
- In the 21st century church, we care even less about doctrine
 - “We should not worry about doctrine; we should focus on preaching the Gospel.”
 - What are you preaching? What are you telling people they need to believe?

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4 Rules for Guarding the Church

1.

Our doctrine must be guarded by a written confessional standard approved by the congregation.

2.

The group that guards the church must be biblically qualified men.

3.

This group must not be a rotating council/committee.

4.

This confession must be enforced uniformly.

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Rule 1

1.

Our doctrine must be guarded by a written confessional standard approved by the congregation.

- If there is no standard, then what doctrine will be allowed in the church will depend upon the opinion of the men guarding it
- If one person is more convincing than the rest, he will control the doctrine of the church
- Personal feelings and emotions will sway the decision of the group
- A confessional standard gives clarity
- It must be the congregation that decides the doctrinal standards

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Rule 1 – Some Challenges

1.

Our doctrine must be guarded by a written confessional standard approved by the congregation.

- This is not a simple task
- The church must decide how narrow they want their doctrine to be and where they are comfortable with disagreement
- If the BFM 2000 (1963?) is not strong enough for the church, the church should write something that reflects their beliefs specifically to accompany the BFM
 - If we update our bylaws, it may be good to consider this while doing so
- People will leave the church over this, but the church will then have unity from which they can build

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Rule 2

2.

The group that guards the church must be biblically qualified men.

- Scriptures calls for elders to protect the church (Acts 20:28-31; 1 Peter 5:2-3)
- The men who protect the church must have a strong understanding of church's doctrine and theology
- They should be able to recognize theological language, historical heresies, and have a general idea of what the Bible teaches on these matters
- They should have a good understanding of Church History and Baptist History
- Scripture forbids women from teaching in the church and from having authority over men
 - 1 Timothy 2:12 (ESV) - I do not permit a woman to teach or to exercise authority over a man; rather, she is to remain quiet.
 - We disregard scripture to give a woman authority over men who teach in the church

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Rule 3

3.

This group must not be a rotating council/committee.

- This rule is not to say that this group can never change, that would be impossible
- It should not be rotating regularly
- A church needs consistency

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Rule 4

4.

This confession must be enforced uniformly.

- Having a confession is not enough
- SBTS failed to enforce the *Abstract of Principles* the way it was originally intended
- This confession must be applied equally to all
- One person cannot be allowed to teach against it while another is blocked
- Everyone who teaches in a church must be tried and tested
- Yes, this limits who teaches in a church, but is that a bad thing?

162



Thinking on Modern Education

163

The Fathers and Education

- The Founding Fathers of the United States were major proponents of education
- They believed that a proper education was necessary for a republic to survive and thrive
- Many of them supported state funded education and they began laying the groundwork for public education

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“

There shall be reserved for the United States out of every township, the four lots, being numbered 8, 11, 26, 29, and out of every fractional part of a township, so many lots of the same numbers as shall be found thereon, for future sale. There shall be reserved the lot No. 16, of every township, for the maintenance of public schools within the said township; also one third part of all gold, silver, lead and copper mines, to be sold, or otherwise disposed of, as Congress shall hereafter direct.

”

The Land Ordinance of 1785

165

“

Religion, morality, and knowledge, being necessary to good government and the happiness of mankind, schools and the means of education shall forever be encouraged.

”

Northwest Ordinance of 1787

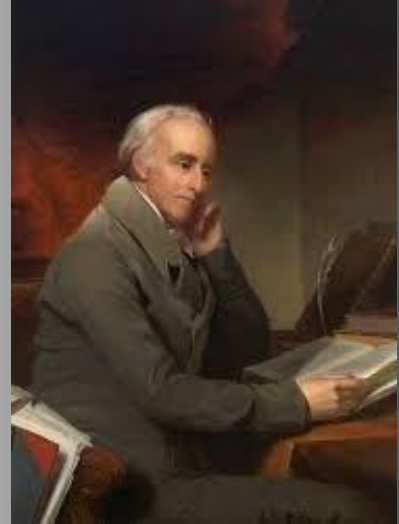
166

“

From the observations that have been made it is plain that I consider it as possible to convert men into republican machines. This must be done if we expect them to perform their parts properly in the great machine of the government of the state. That republic is sophisticated with monarchy or aristocracy that does not revolve upon the wills of the people, and these must be fitted to each other by means of education before they can be made to produce regularity and unison in government.

”

Benjamin Rush, "Thoughts Upon the Mode of Education Proper in a Republic," 1786



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The Fathers and Education

- What kind of education did the Founding Fathers have in mind?
- What would they think of the educational system today?

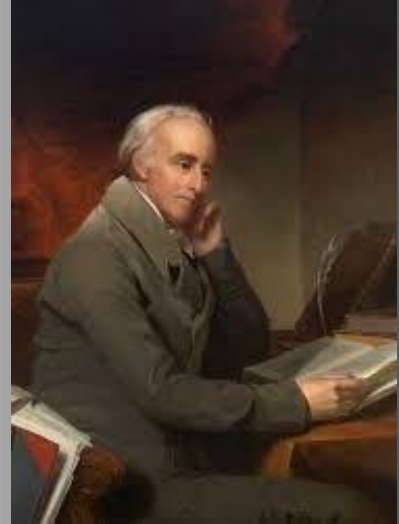
168

“

I proceed in the next place, to enquire, what mode of education we shall adopt so as to secure to the state all the advantages that are to be derived from the proper instruction of youth; and here I beg leave to remark, that the only foundation for a useful education in a republic is to be laid in Religion. Without this there can be no virtue, and without virtue there can be no liberty, and liberty is the object and life of all republican governments.

”

Benjamin Rush, “Of the Mode of Education Proper in a Republic”, 1798



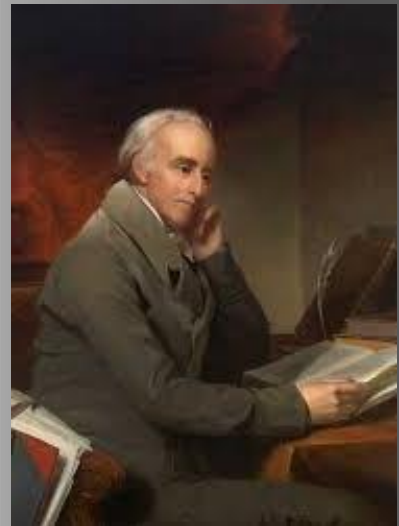
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“

I am aware that I dissent from one of those paradoxical opinions with which modern times abound: that it is improper to fill the minds of youth with religious prejudices of any kind and that they should be left to choose their own principles after they have arrived at an age in which they are capable of judging for themselves. Could we preserve the mind in childhood and youth a perfect blank, this plan of education would have more to recommend it, but this we know to be impossible. The human mind runs as naturally into principles as it does after facts. It submits with difficulty to those restraints or partial discoveries which are imposed upon it in the infancy of reason. Hence the impatience of children to be informed upon all subjects that relate to the invisible world. But I beg leave to ask, Why should we pursue a different plan of education with respect to religion from that which we pursue in teaching the arts and sciences? Do we leave our youth to acquire systems of geography, philosophy, or politics till they have arrived at an age in which they are capable of judging for themselves? We do not. I claim no more, then, for religion than for the other sciences, and I add further that if our youth are disposed after they are of age to think for themselves, a knowledge of one system will be the best means of conducting them in a free inquiry into other systems of religion, just as an acquaintance with one system of philosophy is the best introduction to the study of all the other systems in the world.

”

Benjamin Rush, "Thoughts Upon the Mode of Education Proper in a Republic," 1786



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“

Of all the dispositions and habits which lead to political prosperity, religion and morality are indispensable supports. In vain would that man claim the tribute of patriotism who should labor to subvert these great pillars of human happiness, these firmest props of the duties of men and citizens. The mere politician, equally with the pious man, ought to respect and to cherish them. A volume could not trace all their connections with private and public felicity. Let it simply be asked where is the security for property, for reputation, for life, if the sense of religious obligation desert the oaths, which are the instruments of investigation in courts of justice? And let us with caution indulge the supposition that morality can be maintained without religion. Whatever may be conceded to the influence of refined education on minds of peculiar structure, reason and experience both forbid us to expect that national morality can prevail in exclusion of religious principle.

”

George Washington's Farewell Address to the People of the United States of America, 1796



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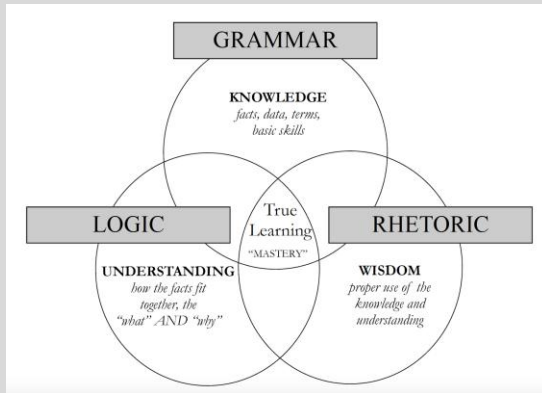
Classical Education



- The dominant form of education in the West until the late 1800s was a “classical education”
- Classical education is built upon the 7 liberal arts:
 - The Trivium
 - The Quadrivium

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Trivium

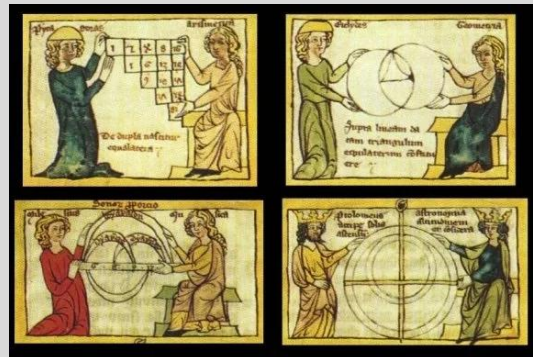


- The Trivium consists of three parts
 - Grammar
 - Logic
 - Rhetoric
- The Trivium is used as a primary education

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Quadrivium

- As a child matures, they move into the Quadrivium
- The Quadrivium is made up of 4 parts:
 - Arithmetic
 - Music
 - Geometry
 - Astronomy



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Developing Minds

- The basis of Classical Education is to develop human beings who think
- It sets the mind free ("Liberal" Arts)
- In Classical Education, an emphasis is placed upon teaching Latin and Greek
- Students are to read and learn from the great thinkers of Western Civilization
- They learn to engage with the people who shaped our culture and they learn how our culture has developed
- In a Classical *Christian* Education, students learn to engage with these great thinkers from a biblical worldview

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Early American Education

- There was no organized American education in the 1700-1800s
- Schools were run by towns, churches, and communities
- One of the primary motives for education was to read the Bible
- Education depended on your social status
- Most education was given in families
- In the 18th century, around 70% of men in the colonies were literate, compared to 40% in Britain and 29% in France

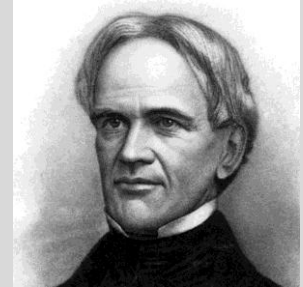


Pages from the New England Primer

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The Public School System

- Horace Mann is widely considered the “father of American public education”
- He was influenced by the Prussian education system
- He believed that schools should:
 - Be tax funded
 - Be universal and mandated by the state
 - Be required for all children
 - Be taught by professional teachers
 - Not be sectarian (holding to one religious group or doctrine)



Horace Mann (1796-1859)

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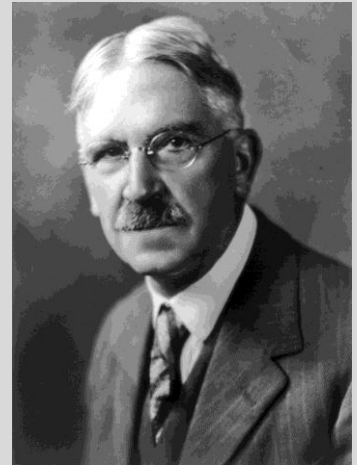
Changing Ideals

- There were many things that shaped education in the 19th century
- Industrialization
 - A move from the farm to the factory caused there to be needs for specialized workforces
 - Schools were modeled after the factory
- Enlightenment
 - The birth of evolution and other scientific ideologies
 - Cultural shift away from religion
- Pragmatic Philosophy
 - A philosophical approach that emphasizes personal experience in shaping understanding and truth
 - Theories and beliefs are evaluated off their practical application

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The Influence of Dewey

- John Dewey was a philosopher and educator and is one of the biggest influencers of the American education system
- “I believe that education is the fundamental method of social progress and reform.” – Dewey, *My Pedagogic Creed*
- He believed that education needed to be progressive
- He promoted student-centered learning
- He also promoted experiential learning (learning by doing)



John Dewey (1859-1952)

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Removing Religion

- From the early 1800s to the mid-1900s, education in America has drifted from classical education to a modern progressive STEM education
- Over this time, we have been removing what people see as “not useful” for education
- School sponsored prayer and Bible devotions were officially removed from public schools in 1962-1963

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**Can a TRUE education of human beings
be separate from God?**

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What should we do then?

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